



## How can you select an impact evaluation design based on its appropriateness, feasibility, affordability and credibility?

The purpose of this Impact Evaluation Suitability Check (G12) is to assess the most appropriate, feasible, affordable, and credible impact evaluation design type to use when evaluating any particular agency, provider, policy, or initiative.

As you move down the impact evaluation design types within this tool, you can see that it shows that the appropriateness, feasibility, and affordability of the design types is increasing. However, while you are moving down the design types, you should also note that the level of credibility of some design types for some critical stakeholders can also change. The credibility of impact design types for critical stakeholders generally (but not always, depending on the views of the stakeholder) reduces as you move downward within the tool.

Using this tool, you can go through each impact evaluation design type and assess its appropriateness, feasibility, affordability, and credibility for evaluating a particular organization, agency, provider, policy, or initiative and then use this to work out which type of impact evaluation to use in a particular case.

As pointed out in the When Purchasers/Funders and Control Agencies Should Consider Alternatives to Impact Evaluation Checklist (G10), purchasers/funders sometimes issue a blanket demand that all agencies, providers, policies, or initiatives undertake impact evaluation. When an organization, agency, supplier/provider, or initiative is faced with this demand, this Impact Evaluation Suitability Check allows them to do 'due diligence' by examining the appropriateness, feasibility, affordability, and credibility of the possible impact evaluation design type. They can then take this analysis back to the purchaser/funder or control agency and have a clear and coherent discussion with them about what type of impact evaluation, if any, is appropriate, feasible, affordable, and credible in their particular situation. This is the most robust way of an organization, agency, provider, policy or initiative to deal with any unreasonable central agency or funder demands regarding impact evaluation.